

Word family: **same / sameness**

Base word: same

Related form: sameness

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / pronoun (代名詞) / adverb-like use in some fixed expressions

Your sentence:

> “At the **same** time, the ad mentioned practical features like comfort, battery life, and sound quality, so it still felt believable.”

A semantic note first: **same** has one very strong core concept rather than many unrelated meanings:

> **two or more things are identical, unchanged, shared, or correspond to one another in some relevant respect**

Most of its variety comes from different grammatical patterns and fixed expressions.

Meaning in this passage

Here, **at the same time** means **simultaneously / during the same period**, and in this sentence it also helps connect two aspects of the advertisement.

繁體中文: **在同一時間; 與另一件事同時發生**

中文翻譯:

> “At the same time, the ad mentioned practical features like comfort, battery life, and sound quality, so it still felt believable.”

「**與此同時**，廣告亦提到了舒適度、電池續航力和音質等實際功能，因此整體仍然令人覺得可信。」

Here:

at the same time = 與前面所描述的事情同時 / 另一方面也同樣存在

1. **the same + noun (事物 / 人物) — 同一個; 完全相同的**

Meaning: Identical rather than different.

Practice 1

> “We bought the **same** model of headphones.”

「我們買了**同一款／完全相同型號的耳機**。」

Practice 2

> “They were wearing the **same** jacket.”

「他們穿著**相同款式的**外套。」

the same = 兩個或以上的人／事物在身分、種類或特徵上完全一致

2. **the same = the identical person/thing (同一人／同一事物) — 同一個**

Sometimes **same** means not merely “similar,” but literally **one identical entity**.

Practice 3

> “We work in the **same** office.”

「我們在**同一個辦公室**工作。」

Practice 4

> “She has used the **same** phone for five years.”

「她五年來一直使用**同一部手機**。」

same = 指的就是同一個具體人物或事物, 而不是另一個相似的

Compare:

> “We have the same phone.”

Depending on context, this usually means **同一款手機**, not that two people physically share one single device.

Context matters.

3. **the same as + person/thing (比較對象) — 與.....相同**

****Meaning:**** Equal or identical in a relevant way to another person or thing.

Practice 5

> “My headphones are the ****same as**** yours.”

「我的耳機跟你的****是一樣的／相同的****。」

Practice 6

> “The price is the ****same as**** last year.”

「價格跟去年****相同，沒有變化****。」

****the same as = 與另一個人、物件、數值或情況相同****

Important grammar:

> ****the same as**** 

> ***the same like*** 

4. ****stay/remain the same (狀態／數值) — 維持不變****

Here, ****same**** emphasizes ****no change over time****.

Practice 7

> “The price has stayed the ****same****.”

「價格一直****維持不變****。」

Practice 8

> “Even after the redesign, the basic idea remained the ****same****.”

「即使重新設計後，基本概念仍然****沒有改變****。」

****remain/stay the same = 經過一段時間或其他變化後，某項特質仍保持原狀****

This is still the core “identity” meaning, applied across ****different times**** rather than different objects.

5. **the same + amount/number/level**(數量／數字／程度) — 數量或程度相等

Meaning: Equal in quantity, measurement, value, or degree.

Practice 9

> “Both products cost the **same** amount.”

「兩件產品的價格**金額相同**。」

Practice 10

> “The two batteries lasted for roughly the **same** length of time.”

「兩顆電池的使用時間**大致相同**。」

same amount/level/size = 比較的數量、程度、尺寸或數值相等

6. **the same = no difference in result/effect**(結果／效果沒有分別) — 都一樣; 沒有分別

Practice 11

> “Either option is fine—the result will be the **same**.”

「兩個選擇都可以, 結果**都是一樣的, 沒有分別**。」

Practice 12

> “Whether I take the train or bus, the travel time is almost the **same**.”

「不論我乘火車還是巴士, 所需時間都**差不多一樣**。」

the same = 不同選擇最後產生相同或沒有實質差異的結果

7. **at the same time**(時間) — 同時; 在同一時間

This is your original use.

Meaning: At one and the same time; simultaneously.

Practice 13 — Original

> “At the **same time**, the ad mentioned practical features...”

「**與此同時**，廣告亦提到了實際功能……」

Practice 14

> “I can’t listen to music and concentrate on this conversation at the **same time**.”

「我不能**同時**聽音樂又專心進行這段對話。」

Practice 15

> “The two trains arrived at the **same time**.”

「兩班火車**同一時間**到達。」

at the same time = 兩件或以上事情在同一時間發生

8. **at the same time** (論述連接) — 與此同時; 另一方面

This deserves attention because it is slightly different from literal simultaneity.

Meaning: Used to add a second, sometimes contrasting, point that is also true.

Practice 16

> “The headphones are expensive. At the **same time**, the sound quality is excellent.”

「這副耳機很昂貴;**但另一方面／與此同時**，音質確實非常出色。」

Practice 17

> “The job is demanding. At the **same time**, it is very rewarding.”

「這份工作要求很高;**不過另一方面**，它也很有滿足感。」

at the same time = 在承認前一點的同時，再補充另一項同樣成立、甚至形成對比的觀點

In your original sentence, there is a little of **both** ideas:

* 同時

* 另一方面也.....

9. **same + person/group (共同擁有／經歷) — 相同的; 共同的**

Meaning: Shared by two or more people.

Practice 18

> “We have the **same** interests.”

「我們有**相同的興趣**。」

Practice 19

> “They faced many of the **same** problems.”

「他們面對很多**共同／相同的問題**。」

same = 兩個或以上的人共同具有相同的特徵、經歷、問題或喜好

10. **the same old + noun (重複而沒有新意) — 老一套的; 一成不變的**

This is a common family extension.

Meaning: Familiar because it keeps happening or appearing again, often with a negative sense of boredom or frustration.

Practice 20

> “It’s the **same old** problem every week.”

「每星期都是**同一個老問題／老一套問題**。」

Practice 21

> “The advertisement used the **same old** promises as every other brand.”

「這則廣告又用了其他品牌都在用的**老一套承諾**。」

****the same old = 不斷重複、沒有新意, 甚至令人厭倦的同一套東西****

11. ****all the same = despite that / nevertheless — 儘管如此; 仍然****

A useful fixed expression.

Practice 22

> “The product is expensive, but I like it ****all the same****.”

「這項產品雖然昂貴, 但我****儘管如此仍然很喜歡它****。」

Practice 23

> “He knew it would be difficult but tried ****all the same****.”

「他知道事情會很困難, 但****仍然照樣嘗試了****。」

****all the same = 即使前面所說的情況成立, 後面的行動／看法仍然不變****

12. ****all the same = no preference / no difference to someone — 對某人而言都一樣****

Practice 24

> “Tea or coffee—it’s ****all the same to me****.”

「茶或咖啡, ****對我來說都一樣, 我沒有偏好****。」

Practice 25

> “We can meet on Monday or Tuesday; it’s ****all the same to me****.”

「星期一或星期二見面都可以, ****對我而言沒有分別****。」

****all the same to someone = 不同選項對某人而言沒有實質差異或偏好****

13. ****same here = 我也是; 我也一樣****

Common conversational expression.

Practice 26

> "I'm exhausted."
> "***Same here.**"

「我累透了。」
「**我也是。**」

Practice 27

> "I really liked the second design."
> "***Same here.**"

「我很喜歡第二個設計。」
「**我也一樣。**」

same here = 表示自己的情況、感受或意見與對方相同

14. **same to you = 你也一樣; 同樣祝福／回應你**

Practice 28

> "Have a great weekend!"
> "***Same to you!**"

「祝你週末愉快！」
「**你也一樣！**」

Practice 29

> "Good luck tomorrow."
> "***Same to you.**"

「祝你明天好運。」
「**也祝你一樣。**」

same to you = 把對方給自己的祝福、評論等以相同內容回給對方

Depending on tone, it can also be sarcastic or hostile, so context matters.

15. **one and the same = actually identical, not two separate things — 根本是同一個; 其實完全相同**

Meaning: Used to emphasize that two names, descriptions, or apparently separate things refer to exactly one thing.

Practice 30

> “The owner and the manager turned out to be **one and the same** person.”

「原來店主和經理**根本就是同一個人**。」

Practice 31

> “These two problems are really **one and the same**.”

「這兩個問題其實**本質上根本是同一件事**。」

one and the same = 強調看似分開的兩者實際上完全是同一個／同一件事

16. **same difference (非正式) — 沒甚麼分別; 差不多一樣**

This is an informal, slightly humorous expression.

Practice 32

> “You call it a mistake; I call it an accident. **Same difference.**”

「你叫它錯誤, 我叫它意外。**反正差不多, 沒甚麼實質分別**。」

Practice 33

> “Six minutes late or seven minutes late—**same difference**.”

「遲六分鐘或遲七分鐘——**其實沒甚麼分別**。」

same difference = 雖然細節不同, 但說話者認為實質結果沒有重要分別

17. **sameness = lack of difference / repetitive similarity — 相同性; 千篇一律**

Here, **sameness** is a noun.

Practice 34

> “There is a certain **sameness** to all the advertisements.”

「這些廣告都有一種**彼此非常相似、缺乏變化的感覺**。」

Practice 35

> “She grew tired of the **sameness** of her daily routine.”

「她厭倦了日常生活那種**日復一日、缺乏變化的單調感**。」

sameness = 事物之間差異很少；亦可指長期缺乏變化而形成的單調感

This form often has a **negative nuance**: too much similarity.

Important distinction: **same vs similar**

Very important.

same

= identical / no relevant difference

> “We bought the **same** headphones.”

「我們買了**同一款／一樣的耳機**。」

similar

= alike, but not necessarily identical

> “We bought **similar** headphones.”

「我們買了**相似但未必完全一樣的耳機**。」

So:

same = 相同

****similar = 相似****

Important distinction: **same vs equal**

**same**

often concerns identity or matching qualities.

> “We chose the same model.”

「我們選了同一款型號。」

**equal**

often concerns amount, value, size, status, or rights.

> “The two payments are equal.”

「兩筆款項金額相等。」

Two objects can be ****equal in size**** without being ****the same object****.

Important distinction: **same vs identical**

**same**

very common and broad.

**identical**

more strongly emphasizes exact matching in every relevant detail.

> “The twins were wearing identical shirts.”

「雙胞胎穿著完全一模一樣的襯衫。」

In everyday English, ****same**** often does the job perfectly well.

Important distinction: **same** vs **unchanged**

same

can compare things with each other **or** compare one thing across time.

unchanged

specifically means no change occurred over time.

> “The price stayed the same.”

= 價格保持不變。

> “The price remained unchanged.”

= 價格維持不變。

The second is more formal and explicitly focuses on change over time.

Important grammar note: **the same**

English normally uses **the** before **same**:

> “the same price” ✓

> “the same person” ✓

> “the same time” ✓

not normally:

> “a same price” ✗

Also:

> **the same as** ✓

> **different from** ✓

> **similar to** ✓

These three patterns are worth memorizing together.

Family-extension note

Following our Golden Manual, the practical family is relatively compact:

- * **same** = 相同的／同一個的
- * **the same as** = 與.....相同
- * **at the same time** = 同時;另一方面
- * **the same old** = 老一套、一成不變
- * **all the same** = 儘管如此;都一樣
- * **same here** = 我也是
- * **same to you** = 你也一樣
- * **one and the same** = 根本就是同一個
- * **same difference** = 實質沒甚麼分別
- * **sameness** = 相同性;缺乏變化的單調感

There is no need to invent many unrelated dictionary senses: most uses come from the core idea of **identity or absence of relevant difference**.

Master comparison

Form / pattern	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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the same + noun	兩個或以上的人／事物在身分、種類或特徵上相同
same — identical entity	指的就是同一個具體人物或事物, 而不是另一個相似的
the same as	與另一個人物、事物、數值或情況相同
stay/remain the same	經過一段時間後仍保持原狀、沒有改變
same amount/level	數量、程度、尺寸或數值相等
the same — result	不同選擇最後產生相同或沒有實質差異的結果
at the same time — literal	兩件或以上事情在同一時間發生
at the same time — discourse	在承認前一點之餘, 再補充另一項同樣成立或形成對比的觀點
same shared experience/feature	兩人或多人共同具有相同的特徵、經歷或問題
the same old	不斷重複、沒有新意甚至令人厭倦的同一套事物
all the same — nevertheless	即使前面的情況成立, 後面的行動或看法仍然不變
all the same to someone	不同選擇對某人而言沒有實質差異或偏好
same here	表示自己的感受、情況或意見與對方相同
same to you	把對方給自己的祝福或評論以相同內容回給對方
one and the same	看似分開的兩者其實完全是同一個／同一件事
same difference	細節雖有差異, 但實質結果沒有重要分別
sameness	差異很少的相同性; 亦可指缺乏變化所造成的單調感

For your original sentence

> “At the ****same time****, the ad mentioned practical features like comfort, battery life, and sound quality...”

The exact meaning is:

****at the same time = 與前面描述的情況同時成立; 同時亦補充另一個重要方面****

So here a very natural translation is:

> ****「與此同時, 廣告亦提到了舒適度、電池續航力和音質等實際功能.....」****

It means the advertisement was ****selling an emotional feeling while simultaneously giving practical, believable product information****.